Lesson notes · for you

Who knows where you are?

Cyber security · Level 2 · Lesson 2

Time
20 min

Materials
Your phone, or a family phone with its owner's permission; Paper and a pen

Learning goals

- Explain how your phone knows where it is.
- Allow only the permissions an app needs.
- Share live location safely, and keep places out of your photos.

Activity: Permission detective

1. Warm-up (3 min): Before you look, write down how many apps you think can use your location. Most people guess too low.
2. Check (7 min): Open Settings, then Location (or Privacy), then app permissions. List every app that can see your location, and next to each one write "always", "while using" or "ask".
3. Decide (5 min): For each app, write whether it needs your location, needs it only while you use it, or doesn't need it at all. Change the settings of the ones that don't need it, with the owner's permission on a family phone.
4. Share (5 min): Compare your table with a partner's. Which app surprised you both? Agree on one rule you'll both keep.

No phone of your own? Do it on a family phone with its owner, or use the four apps in the App permissions lab.

Discussion

- Which app surprised you most?
- When is sharing live location a good idea?
- What could a photo of your street tell a stranger?

Check yourself

- One permission I switched off + why.

Try it this week
Open your phone's settings, find Location, and see which apps can use it. Switch it off for any app that doesn't need it, and check who can see your live location. If it's a family phone, do it with the person who owns it.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **You shared live location with your class group for a party, and it's still on the next morning. What should you do?**

◯ Stop it now ◯ Leave it: they're my classmates ◯ Leave it, but mute the group

2 **You want your family to see you get home safely after training. Put the steps in order.**

☐ Choose Live location, and pick one hour

☐ When you're home, check that sharing has stopped

☐ Before you leave, open the chat with your family, not a group

☐ Tap Share, then set off home

3 **A photo app lets you take photos and edit them. It asks for these permissions. Which does it really need?**

☐ Your exact location ☐ Sending text messages ☐ Your contacts ☐ Your photos

☐ The camera

4 **If you switch off location on your phone, nobody at all can tell roughly where your phone is.**

◯ True ◯ False

✎ **Which app on your phone, or the family phone, knows the most about where you go? Did you choose that, or did it happen by accident?**

Check your answers

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1 **Stop it now**

While it's on, the whole group can follow you everywhere, and some of those phones may be lost, shared or read by others.

2 **Top to bottom: 2, 4, 1, 3**

Pick who and how long before you tap Share, so you never share more than you meant: your family, not a group, for an hour.

3 **Your photos; The camera**

It needs your photos to edit them (many phones let you give it only the ones you pick), and the camera to take new ones.

4 **False**

Apps can no longer use your location, but your mobile network still knows which masts your phone is near: that is how calls reach you.